LESSON 5

Jingle Bells

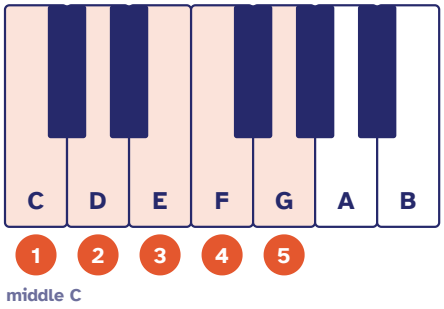
Written by James Lord Pierpont and published in 1857, as a song for a winter sleigh ride.

IN THIS SONG **the same note again** **long notes** **letters on C and G only** **C position**

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

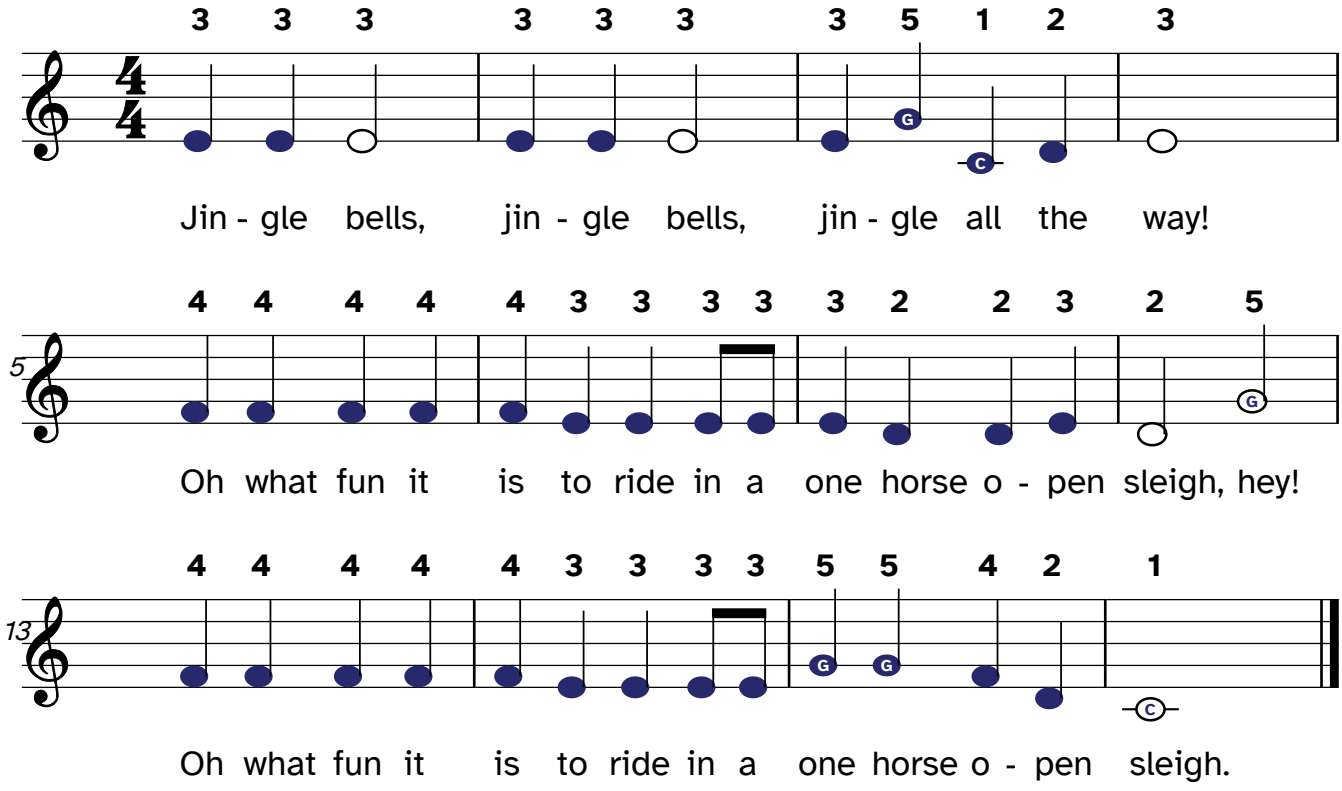
1 Listen and sing

Listen, pointing to each note. The song goes: line 1, line 2, then line 1 again and line 3. The same note comes again and again: keep the beat steady.



Your hand: the C position. Thumb on middle C, all five fingers up to G.

Only C and G keep their letters now. Find the others from them: E is on the bottom line, a skip below G.



☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Sang it with the words** ☐ **Held the long notes**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE TIME

4/4

Top 4: four beats in every bar.

Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

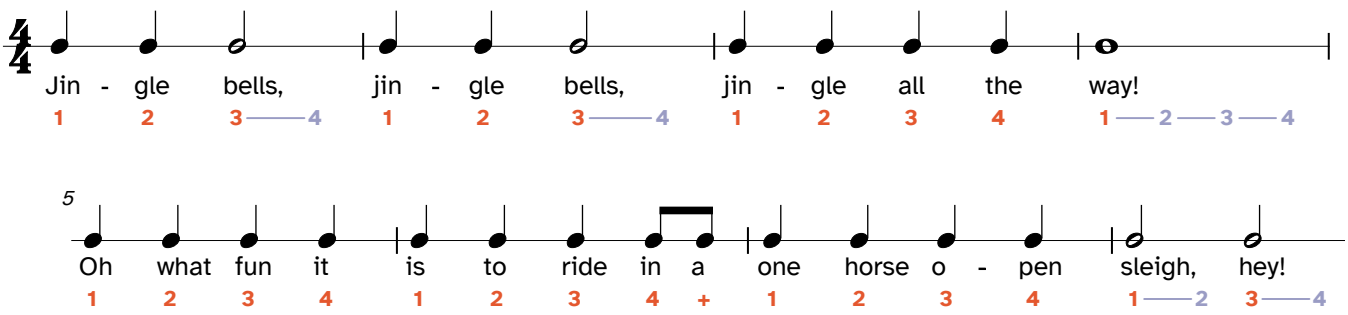
THE NOTES

crotchet: walk
1 beat

two quavers: run-ning
1 beat

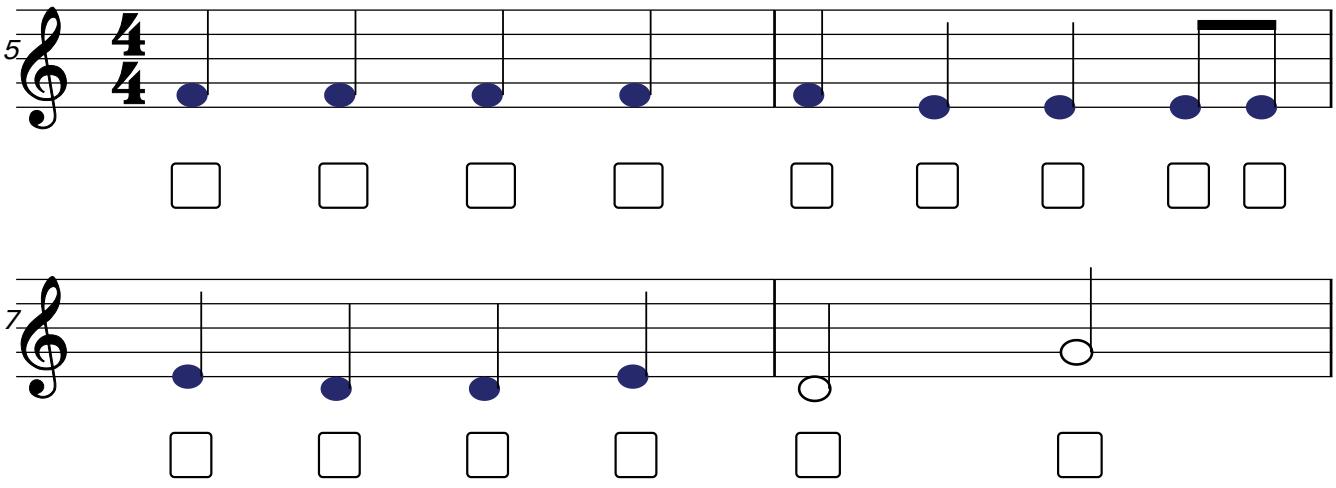
minim: hold
2 beats

semibreve: hold-2-3-4
4 beats



THE NOTES

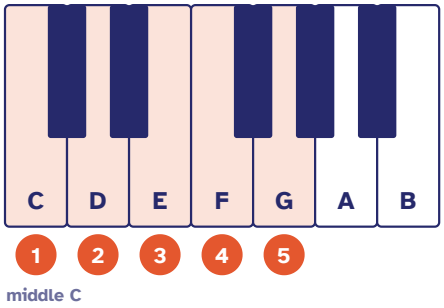
Only C and G are named in the song now. Write the letter under each note of these bars.



- [ ] **Said it in time**
- [ ] **Clapped and counted**
- [ ] **Wrote the letter names**
- [ ] **Held every semibreve for 4**

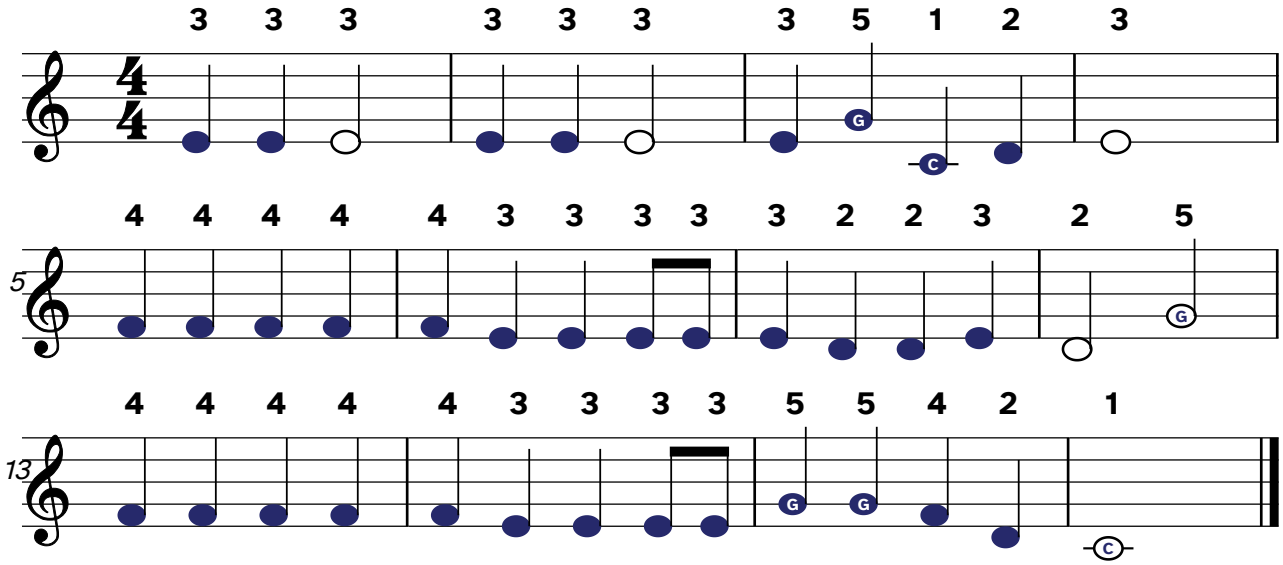
3 Play it

All five fingers in the C position. The right hand plays it all; then the left hand plays the first line, an octave lower.

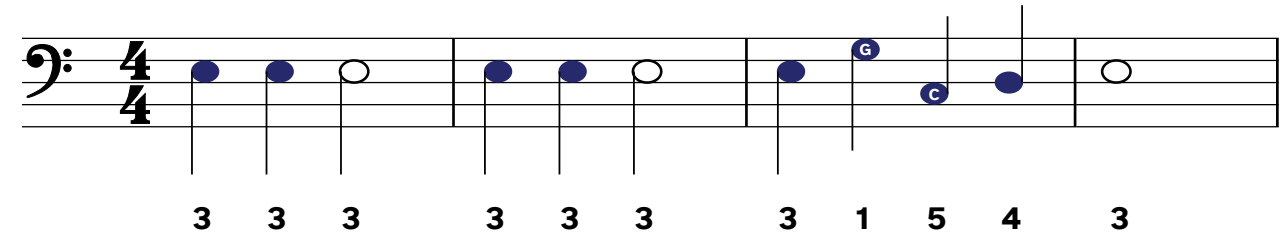


Right hand: thumb on middle C, 1 to 5 up to G. **Left hand:** an octave lower, on the King's staff: his sign's two dots wrap round F. Thumb on G, down to 5 on C.

R RIGHT HAND lines 1, 2, 1 again, then 3



L LEFT HAND line 1, the King's staff, an octave lower



4 · CHECK

- ☐ I can say and clap it
- ☐ I can sing it with the words
- ☐ I can find C and G and count from them

I can play it:

- ☐ Right hand ☐ Left hand

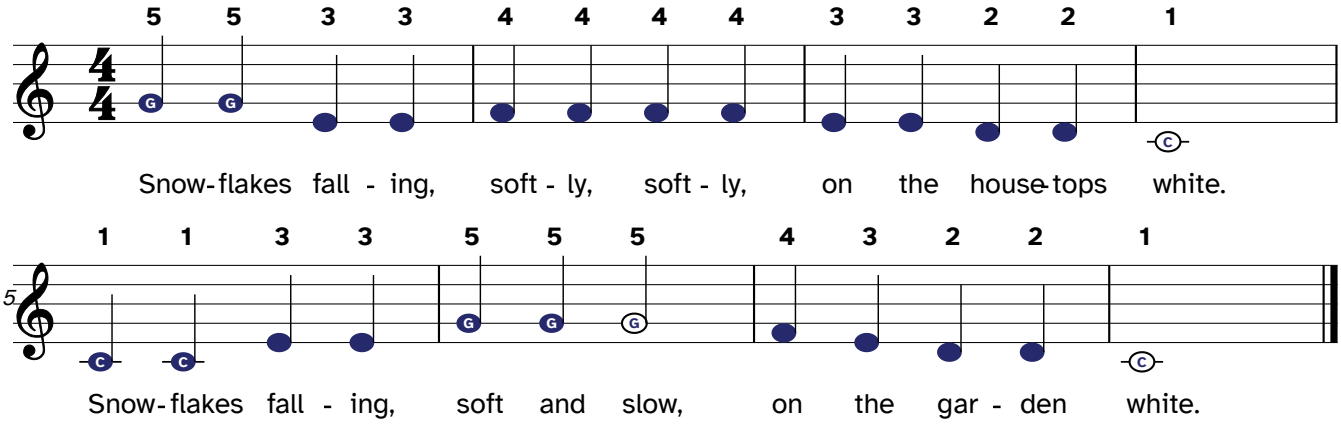
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

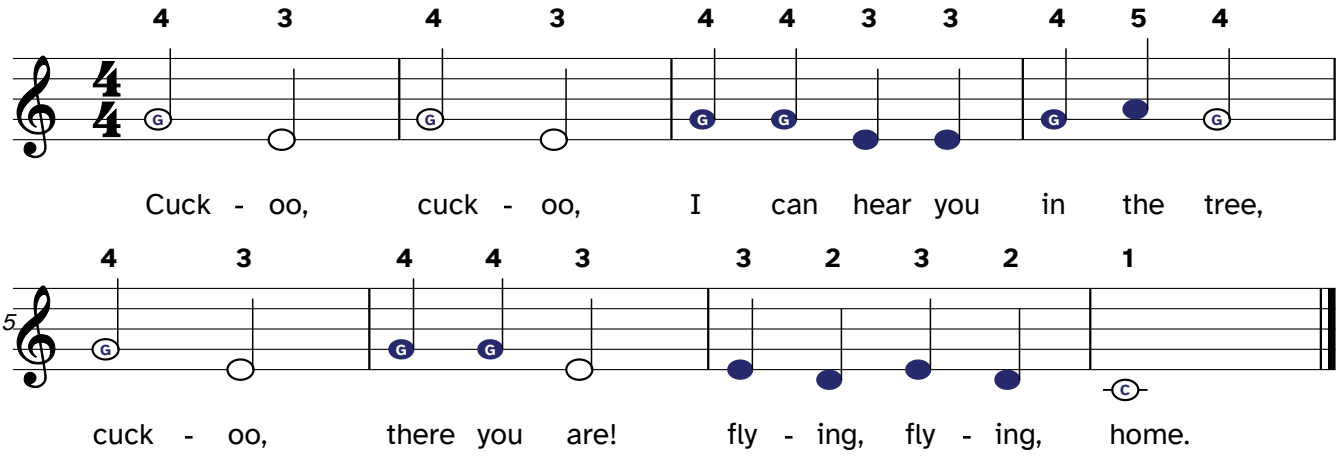
SNOWFLAKES

Notes that come again, and a long one to hold at the end of each line.



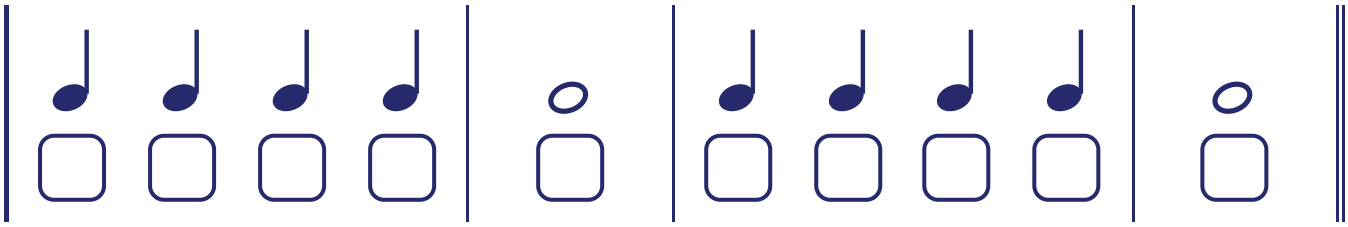
CUCKOO

A peek at Lesson 6: G and E, the cuckoo's call, and in bar 4 finger 5 reaches up to A, one key past G.



YOUR OWN TUNE

Write a letter in each box, then play your tune. Give it a name: _____



☐ **Played the first tune** ☐ **Played the second tune** ☐ **Played my own tune**